Routledge Studies in Affective Societies

Series Editors:
Birgitt Röttger-Rössler
Professor of Social and Cultural Anthropology at Freie Universität Berlin, Germany
Doris Kolesch
Professor of Theater and Performance Studies at Freie Universität Berlin, Germany

Routledge Studies in Affective Societies presents high-level academic work on the social dimensions of human affectivity. It aims to shape, consolidate and promote a new understanding of societies as Affective Societies, accounting for the fundamental importance of affect and emotion for human coexistence in the mobile and networked worlds of the 21st century. Contributions come from a wide range of academic fields, including anthropology; sociology; cultural, media and film studies; political science; performance studies; art history; philosophy; and social, developmental and cultural psychology. Contributing authors share the vision of a transdisciplinary understanding of the affective dynamics of human sociality. Thus, *Routledge Studies in Affective Societies* devotes considerable space to the development of methodology, research methods and techniques that are capable of uniting perspectives and practices from different fields.

Affect in Relation
Families, Places, Technologies
Edited by Birgitt Röttger-Rössler and Jan Slaby

Image Testimonies
Witnessing in Times of Social Media
Edited by Kerstin Schankweiler, Verena Straub and Tobias Wendl

Affective Societies
Key Concepts
Edited by Jan Slaby and Christian von Scheve

Analyzing Affective Societies
Methods and Methodologies
Edited by Antje Kahl

For more information about this series, please visit: www.routledge.com/Routledge-Studies-in-Affective-Societies/book-series/RSAS

Analyzing Affective Societies

Methods and Methodologies

Edited by Antje Kahl

Routledge
Taylor & Francis Group
LONDON AND NEW YORK

First published 2019
by Routledge
2 Park Square, Milton Park, Abingdon, Oxon OX14 4RN

and by Routledge
52 Vanderbilt Avenue, New York, NY 10017

Routledge is an imprint of the Taylor & Francis Group, an informa business

© 2019 selection and editorial matter, Antje Kahl; individual chapters, the contributors

The right of Antje Kahl to be identified as the author of the editorial material, and of the authors for their individual chapters, has been asserted in accordance with sections 77 and 78 of the Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988.

All rights reserved. No part of this book may be reprinted or reproduced or utilised in any form or by any electronic, mechanical, or other means, now known or hereafter invented, including photocopying and recording, or in any information storage or retrieval system, without permission in writing from the publishers.

Trademark notice: Product or corporate names may be trademarks or registered trademarks, and are used only for identification and explanation without intent to infringe.

British Library Cataloguing-in-Publication Data
A catalogue record for this book is available from the British Library

Library of Congress Cataloging-in-Publication Data
A catalog record for this book has been requested

ISBN: 978-1-138-38879-6 (hbk)
ISBN: 978-0-429-42436-6 (ebk)

Typeset in Times New Roman
by Apex CoVantage, LLC

Contents

Notes on contributors viii
Acknowledgments xiv

1 Introduction: analyzing affective societies 1
ANTJE KAHL

2 Concepts as methodology: a plea for arrangement thinking in the study of affect 27
JAN SLABY, RAINER MÜHLHOFF AND PHILIPP WÜSCHNER

PART I
Textualities 43

3 Reading for affect: a methodological proposal for analyzing affective dynamics in discourse 45
ANNA L. BERG, CHRISTIAN VON SCHEVE, N. YASEMIN URAL AND ROBERT WALTER-JOCHUM

4 Interviews as situated affective encounters: a relational and processual approach for empirical research on affect, emotion and politics 63
BILGIN AYATA, CILJA HARDERS, DERYA ÖZKAYA AND DINA WAHBA

5 Narrating visualized feelings: photovoice as a tool for researching affects and emotions among school students 78
BIRGITT RÖTTGER-RÖSSLER, GABRIEL SCHEIDECKER AND ANH THU ANNE LAM

Chapter 8

Analyzing affective media practices by the use of video analysis

Margreth Lünenborg and Tanja Maier

1. Introduction

One core argument of affect theory refers to the capacity of affects to spill over from one body to another, from human to non-human bodies and vice versa (Angerer, 2017; Gregg & Seigworth, 2010). If we take this argument not just metaphorically, but want to understand more precisely *how affect works*, we need to look empirically at situations where affects cross borders and become visible in bodies of different kinds. As we are interested in the affecting dynamics of media, we want to apply affect studies to audience research. Understanding media as a relevant "affect generator" (Reckwitz, 2017), we want to analyze how these dynamics become relevant for media audiences. To do so, we use video analysis, watching people while watching television. In this chapter, we will give insights into our work with video material and its potential to shed light on the affective dynamics of media audiences.

Before going into empirical details, we will first give some background on the research context in which our work with video data has been developed. In a next step, we flesh out basic understandings of media audience and its relation to affects and emotions. As we refer to an understanding of affect based in practice theory, we will explore in more details how audiences and their media practices are conceptualized in practice theory approaches (Part 3). The empirical steps working with video analysis follow in Part 4, including the collection of video data, the contextualization of video material worked out with situational maps, and methodological considerations towards different tools available for in-depth analyses of the digital video material. Finally, we reflect on the potential of video analysis and its limitations, discussing especially the changing contexts of media use with digital and mobile devices and its relevance for grasping the affective practices of media audiences (Part 5).

2. Affect theory as research context in audience studies

While affect studies has been focusing quite intensively on the analysis of media texts (e.g. Breger, 2014; Coleman, 2013; Fahlenbrach, 2010), work on the affective

dynamics of the audience is still scarce. On the other hand, considerations about the audience within affect studies is mostly based on theoretical conceptualizations of the audience while empirical approaches are missing (Gibbs, 2011). Thus, affect theory delivers complex theoretical understandings of affects as driving forces moving people to engage with media, but little is known about how affects become observable, how they are acted out or how the relational character of affect becomes relevant during the process of media reception and appropriation.

Our approach to the analysis of affective practices of the audience is part of a research project on *Transcultural Emotional Repertoires in and by Reality TV*. Analyzing reality TV as a global media format, we are interested in the affective dynamics produced in and by these shows. We understand reality TV formats as regulating forces organizing acceptable and privileged expressions and performances of emotions, while others are marked as undesirable. These socially and culturally formed emotions are not primarily part of discourse and meaning production in these formats, but are mostly affectively produced as relational intensities between human bodies and media technology. Above all, we are interested in the relational character of affect and want to capture it with our empirical analysis. Understanding affect as a dynamic, processual and fluid capacity coming up in the relational interaction *between* actors, artifacts, temporal and spatial contexts (Blackman & Venn, 2010; Clough, 2000, 2007; Slaby, Mühlhoff, & Wüschner, 2016).

We ask how affective dynamics emerge through globally distributed popular media formats like talent shows, both on the level of production and broadcasting and among culturally diverse audiences. Central to this analysis are thus the affect-based dynamic-relational processes of reception and appropriation of reality TV. The performative construction of emotional border situations, their affective shifts, and their provoked transgressions are essential ingredients of such TV shows. At their center are seemingly universal emotional concepts, such as success/failure or pride/shame, which are locally transformed and adopted to successfully reach local audiences (Grüne, 2016; Kraidy & Sender, 2011). The format itself thus regulates the performance of emotions. An ensemble of such repetitive, socially rooted and regulated verbal and non-verbal emotional forms of expression and behavior can be described as an emotional repertoire. Emotions are ordered, evaluated and circulated through such emotional repertoires. Media products can be understood as a repository, carrier, mediator as well as a context for the production and negotiation of emotional repertoires. Social norms and values of the appropriateness of emotions are displayed and performed in audiovisual media. In reality TV, protagonists representing preferably contrastive lifestyles and culturally diverse backgrounds embody these emotional repertoires in a complex interaction of performed personal articulations and dramaturgically staged conflictive settings. The contrastive casting of protagonists ensures conflictive dynamics in the show and enables a diversity of viewers to be involved emotionally. The concepts, symbols and enactments of emotions and affects communicated by these shows address a culturally diverse audience. We inquire into

the potential for these shows to offer affective belonging to their audiences. Since the focus in reality TV is less on substantial discursive meaning production than on affectively based provocation, indignation or enthusiasm, we are interested in the effects of these very affections. We are especially interested in understanding the affective dynamics of negotiating modes of belonging in and by these popular TV formats. These belongings may refer to the cultural background as well as to social, gendered or sexual affiliations. Thus, we are looking for such forms of negotiation in the TV format itself as well as on the side of the audience.

With our research interest, we add a new focus to this field of research. Scholars like Kavka (2008, 2014) and Bratich (2007, 2010) have offered an analysis of affect *in* reality TV. Yet less has been written on its potential for the analysis of audiences. Skeggs and Wood (2012) have conducted research on the audience of reality TV focusing on the affective dynamics pertaining to the social and cultural backgrounds of audience members. They used interviews, focus group discussions and audio recordings of reception settings – called "text-in-action-viewing sessions" (Wood, 2007) and "text-in-action-method" (Wood, 2009, 100–117) – to scrutinize reactions of the audience to the program shown. We build on this work, but add with video analysis another empirical approach to an understanding of the affective practices.

To explain in more detail how affect can be implemented in the analysis of audiences, we start by introducing theories of practice as a theoretical conceptualization in audience research. Understanding activities of the audience as routinized parts of everyday life helps us to formulate watching television as a social activity performed in specific settings characterized by social as well as spatial contexts and constraints. However, focusing on practices enables us not just to understand routines, but ruptures as well, as they are based on shifts in elements of practice allowing for change. These considerations about audience activities as social practices are carried forward by a more detailed elaboration of affect grounded in practice theory.

3. Understanding affect with practice theory

Practice theory represents an interdisciplinary body of scholarship at the intersection of sociology (Bourdieu, 1977), media anthropology (Postill & Bräuchler, 2010) and cultural studies (Hall, 1997). An important strand of practice theory can also be traced back to pragmatist philosophy and the sociology of knowledge (Schatzki, 1996; Schatzki, Knorr-Cetina, & von Savigny, 2001). Given the great variety of practice-based approaches, it is common to speak of theories of practice as an 'argument' about the mutual constitution of social structures and human agency (Ortner, 1996, 2). Theories of practice reject both methodological individualism and holism as causes of sociality (Hillebrandt, 2014, 27), and foreground that neither agents nor structures alone explain the continuity of social relations. Practices, in contrast, are conceived as routines where structures and

actors encounter and impact each other. With a marked focus on the "'everyday' and 'life-world'", practice theories are centered on the "shared knowledge" that actors use in the "symbolic organization of reality" (Reckwitz, 2002b, 244–246; see also Garfinkel, 1967; Lefebvre, 2014). Understanding the everyday as a "particular material setting" of social life, quotidian practices account for the "organization generating its ordinary features, its orders and disorders, its contingencies and conditions" (Smith, 1987, 99). The quotidian can thus not be reduced to a complacent or monotonous routine of action, but describes a negotiation in practice between "relations of enablement and constraint" (Schatzki, 2002, 99).

The incorporated (and often implicit) knowledge deployed in practice is embodied – that is, learned in "bodily mental routines" (Reckwitz, 2003, 256). However, it is also performed, and is recognized by others as a legitimate course of action or conduct in a given situation (Reckwitz, 2002a). Due to this strong emphasis on incorporation of knowledge, practice theories can be seen as "a body of work about the work of the body" (Postill & Bräuchler, 2010, 11).

In media and communication studies, practice theories have been taken up especially in the field of audience and reception studies (Postill & Bräuchler, 2010) and in research about the 'domestication' of new technologies focusing especially on the routinized patterns of everyday interaction with media (Bakardjieva, 2005; Couldry, Livingstone, & Markham, 2007; Hartmann, 2013; Röser, Thomas, & Peil, 2010). Couldry's landmark article "Theorising Media as Practice" (2004) became a strategic statement that advocated placing "media studies firmly within a broader sociology of action and knowledge" (Couldry, 2004, 117) and regarded the multiple embeddedness of media in everyday life – rather than only their texts, their socio-political or economic structures – as a primary research interest. Thus, practice theory follows an approach designated as "non-media-centric media studies" (Krajina, Moores, & Morley, 2014). As Couldry (2012, 43) pointed out: "The value of practice theory is to ask open questions about what people are doing in relation to media. . . . A practice approach also brings into view the wider articulations of practices in systems of power". In this light, our focus on the affective dimension of social practices with media presumes that "*every* social order as a set of practices is a specific order of affects" (Reckwitz, 2017, 116, italics by the author).

In audience research, rare concepts do exist that describe and theorize the relation between media practices and affects. As Gibbs (2011, 251) writes: "To date, affect has been a category that has made more impact in media theory than in audience studies – in fact, affect theory has not yet been seriously adopted at all by audience research". For our analysis, we use an approach that combines elements of media practice theory with affect theory for the study of audiences. This gives us the opportunity to achieve two goals: to systematically describe and conceptualize the "affected body" of members of the audience in media communication, and to analyze in depth the potential of affective belongings that reality TV shows offer to their audiences. Thus, a special emphasis will be placed on exploring

structures of difference and power in relation to affective dynamics. For this reason, we would like to open up the discussion to "affective practices" (Reckwitz, 2017; Wetherell, 2012, 2015). As Wetherell (2015) suggests:

> A practice approach positions affect as a dynamic process, emergent from a polyphony of intersections and feedbacks, working across body states, registrations and categorizations, entangled with cultural meaning-making, and integrated with material and natural processes, social situations and social relationships.
>
> (p. 139)

Following Wetherell, we understand affective media practices as relational actions, which connect bodies (human and non-human, like technologies) and media text in specific mediated situations and emphasize bodily aspects of media practices in particular. As Wetherell (2012) has summarized:

> An affective practice is a figuration where body possibilities and routines become recruited or entangled together with meaning-making and with other social and material figurations. It is an organic complex in which all parts relationally constitute each other.
>
> (p. 19)

Relying on the understanding of relational affectivity as a concept of affect and emotion (e.g. von Scheve, 2017), we elaborate on the bodily dimension between media text and viewers as well as between members of the media audience. Our considerations will be exemplified by the case of television. In this view, affective practices of media consumption have the potential to bind individuals and collectives together or delineate them from one another. Such a practice "*orients the body in some ways rather than others*" (Ahmed, 2010, 247, italics by the author). This might refer to the sense of belonging to a (sub)culture or to imagined communities constituted by gender, sexuality or cultural background. We outline some preliminary thoughts about the relevance of affects for the production of belonging by and through popular media texts.

But how can we carry out such affect media studies in practice? In this chapter, we argue that (digital) video analysis and some tools based in situational analysis (Clarke, 2005) can help to analyze affective practices in television culture.

4. Video analysis and audience research

Our empirical approach combines textual television analysis and digital video analysis. The empirical basis is the 11th season of *Germany's Next Topmodel* from 2016. Our audience research, among other materials, used digital video data for the analysis of affective media practices. By video analysis, we mean mainly the audiovisual recordings that are created by the researchers for *reception and audience studies* – not recordings produced by other actors, may it be professional TV shows or clips shared on video-sharing websites (Knoblauch, 2012, 253). This, however, does not exclude the possibility of using further video recordings (of TV shows for instance) in the analysis. We will return to this topic further in the chapter.

In order to understand media practices, audience studies of television have usually used interviews as data or ethnographic approaches (e.g. Rose, 2006, 202–215). Video analysis as method and methodology is rarely found in relevant introductory literature and handbooks of qualitative research methods in communication and media studies (Gjedde & Ingemann, 2008; Schünzel & Knoblauch, 2017). In ethnographic and social science research, by contrast, there is a range of literature on video analysis and videography for the study of social interaction (e.g. Heath, Hindmarsh, & Luff, 2010; Kissmann, 2009; Knoblauch, Schnettler, & Tuma, 2014; Pink, 2001, 2006). Among other reasons, epistemological and methodological considerations are important reasons why researchers increasingly choose video analytical methods:

> Compared to observations made by the naked human eye, video recordings appear more detailed, more complete and more accurate. In a technical sense, they are more reliable since they allow data analysis independent of the person who collected the data.
>
> (Knoblauch, Schnettler, & Raab, 2006, 10)

The growing use of video recording in research practice is also related to the alternative offered by digital video technology that has improved the quality of the recording techniques and brought upon new possibilities of video analysis that span data collection, processing and the analysis process (e.g. Irion, 2002; Dinkelaker & Herrle, 2009).

Collecting and post-production of audiovisual data with video material

Lightweight, easy-to-use and mobile digital cameras open up possibilities for collecting audiovisual material in everyday situations of media consumption with increased flexibility, spontaneity and under limited burden. Digital technology has also optimized the possibilities of recording in poorly lit settings or without artificial light. Thus, it is now possible to obtain some useable image quality in suboptimal recording settings with limited strain, for instance, while watching TV in the evening at home. In our project, we recorded living rooms at home using two digital cameras installed on tripods to the left and right of the couch. Since we are interested in the process of affectively based belonging while watching TV, we have analyzed groups as well as couples in their everyday settings.

For our study, we record the reception process in front of the TV in the private living rooms as well as the TV show on the screen. Based on our theoretical approach, we assume that affection arises between media text and technologies

and the body of the viewers. Therefore, it is necessary to develop an approach that circumvents the dualism of text research on the one hand and reception analysis on the other. As our aim is to analyze the bodily relation between the medium and the person watching, we used split-screen videos as a tool. Thus, using video editing software, one can synchronize the footage of the social situation in front of the TV with the TV show running at that moment. The split-screen is an excellent tool for analyzing what the bodies of the watching participants react to. For further detailed analysis of the material, we used other tools such as slow motion, time lapse, zooms, stills as well as the 'subtitling' of the footage with transcripts made with video editing software.

Mapping approach and relational analysis

Since there is little or no prior knowledge of this subject, we have sought a methodical approach that allows for an inductive procedure. For this reason, we decided to use tools drawn from the *grounded theory methodology* (GTM). More precisely, we use the mapping approach developed by Clarke (2005) in her situational analysis. The situational analysis is theoretically and methodologically in line with constructivist modes of GTM that aim for partial analysis and theory building (Clarke, 2005; Charmaz, 2006). Clarke argues for an understanding of context not as something that surrounds a situation, but as constitutive in itself. She points out:

> *The conditions of the situation are* ***in*** *the situation.* There is no such thing as "context". The conditional elements of the situation need to be specified in the analysis of the situation itself as *they are constitutive of it*, not merely surrounding it or frame it or contributing to it. They *are* it. Regardless of whether some might construe them as local or global, internal or external, close-in or far away or whatever, the fundamental question is "*How do these conditions make themselves felt as consequential – **inside** the empirical situation under examination*?" At least some answers to that question can be found through doing situational analysis.
>
> (Clarke, 2005, 71–72, her emphasis)

Her understanding of situations as constitutive directly relates to our relational understanding of affect. In the following, we consider elements of this approach in order to analyze the effects of affection during joint watching of television programs. Of the tools mentioned by Clarke, however, we only used the so-called 'situational maps', which make it possible to examine relevant elements of a situation and its relations to another:

> **Situational maps** . . . lay out the major human, nonhuman, discursive, and other elements in the research situation of inquiry and provoke analysis of relations among them.
>
> (Clarke, 2005, xxii, her emphasis)

The goal is to analyze this complexity and relationality of the affecting viewer relations and to identify the elements that matter in a specific situation. Affect theory considers the ability of both human and non-human bodies to affect and to be affected. Media texts, technology and indeed any artifacts and materialities, can all affect. Yet the question remains as to which specific elements matter in a particular situation. It is therefore necessary to observe the immediate situation of reception. Thus, we used *messy situational maps* to look at what elements exist and matter in media-related affective settings. According to Clarke, the key questions of situational analyses are "Who and what are in this situation? Who and what matters in this situation? What elements 'make a difference' in the situation?" (Clarke, 2005, 87). In addition, Knudsen and Stage suggested some important and useful research strategies for tracing and characterizing affective dynamics in their book *Affective Methodologies*:

1. formal or stylistic characteristics of communication in affect (e.g. outburst, broken language, hyperbole, redundancy).
2. the intense building of assemblages (consisting of, for example, texts, actions, images, bodies and technologies).
3. non-verbal language and gestures of affected bodies.
4. communicative content about experienced or attributed affect (made by, for example, informants, the researcher him-/herself or in existing texts).
5. the rhythmic intensification, entertainment (through a common pulse) or destabilization of affective energy in relation to specific spaces and (online) sites (Knudsen & Stage, 2015, 9).

In the following, the mentioned questions and procedures will be applied to the specific problems of affect-related media research.

Doing relational analysis with situational maps

To create the situational maps, we initially used the classic open coding strategies of GTM. On the level of open coding, some codes are assigned to the audiovisual material, and initial loose concepts are built without linking them together or comparing them at this stage. Charmaz (2006, 43) defines coding as follows: "Coding means naming segments of data with a label that simultaneously categorizes, summarizes and accounts for each piece of data". The labels she mentions are named codes and are consolidated into concepts during the research (Gibbs, 2007, 39). Concepts are, in this context, a more abstract form of codes. In our definition, we then differentiate the situational concepts that are linked to the specific and empirically analyzed reception situation from the more abstract concepts that are part of the theory and model building. There are fluid transitions between codes – which are more descriptive – and situational and abstract concepts, which are more analytical.

Because we primarily want to identify affective media practices as a phenomenon within reception processes, we coded the entirety of the collected data.

The analysis took place in sequences, although we also followed the units of action of the TV show. To achieve this, we made protocols of the sequences of the analyzed episodes of GNTM that we used as units for the analysis of the video footage. The sequence protocols function as a way of making visible the relation between the affective practices happening in front of the TV screen and the action units of the TV show themselves.

Thus, we watched our audiovisual material several times and then started to create open codes and concepts that summarize what we see happening. Shown as follows is a short transcription of a sequence and an open coding case (see Table 8.1).

Relevant elements of the affective dynamics can be identified through this first step of open coding of the video footage. For instance, the sequence protocol can help pinpoint at what moments of the action specific affective media practices arise. This can then be compared to other cases. The split-screen analysis allows us to investigate the relational character of embodiment between the bodies of the audience and the audiovisual media text at this early stage of data analysis.

Using the codes and concepts, we then created *messy situational maps*. Situational maps capture all relevant elements in the reception situation "in a rough and dirty way in order to represent the field's messiness" (Mathar, 2008). The next question is how these elements are related to each other. Following Clarke, we conducted a relational analysis with situational maps:

> The procedure here is to first make a bunch of photocopies of your best version to date of the situational map. Then you take each element in turn and think about it in relation to each other element on the map. Literally center on one element and draw lines between it and the others and *specify the nature of the relationship by describing the nature of that line*. One does this systematically, one at a time, from every element on the map to every other. Use as many maps as seems useful to diagram yourself through this analytic exercise. This to me is the major work one does with the situational map once it is constructed.
>
> (2005, 102, author's emphasis)

In order to incorporate the bodily relation of people into the media text and media technologies, we then conducted a relational analysis of the affective dynamics at play. To illustrate our qualitative media analysis with situational maps, we have chosen a specific form of affective media practice from our research. In Figure 8.1, we take the concept of "sharing the excitement" as our primary object for a relational analysis with messy situational maps. Figure 8.1 shows, however, only a reduced version of a situational map.

It is important to underline here that the maps are not depictions but tools of analysis. Such maps can be created by hand or using software (we used Microsoft PowerPoint here). Their sole purpose is to illustrate our method of analysis. Figure 8.1 visualizes a relational analysis using a messy situational map, including

Table 8.1 Open Coding Case. Focus on "sharing the excitement".

Timecode	*TV*	*Audience*	*Codes*	*Concept*
01:28:30		A: looks to the left, probably at her cat. Suddenly gets up (and leaves the image). Says: "Check out what she's doing" (talking about her cat in the living room). Comes back after more or less 15 seconds and sits down on the sofa again. Plays with her hair.	glance	affective disengagement
01:30:55	"[. . .] you were always my champion [. . .]"	A: reaction to TV: "Whaaatt???" and looks at B	response-cries	"sharing the excitement" on both sides of the screen
		B: Sitting quietly and watching what's happening. Doesn't react to A	gaze	
		A: Bows forward. Watches in a concentrated way, grabs the last piece of food on the plate near her.	Lean-forward eating	
	"[. . .] you are in the final [. . .]"	B: Gives a loud round of applause, bows forward and laughs	acclamation, lean-forward	
		A: Reacts to her mum and also starts clapping. The candidate rejoices and places her hands on her face. Claps once.	acclamation,	
		B: "She definitely deserved it. She looks like a model".	evaluation	
	" [. . .] she is in the final [. . .] "	A: Picks up Klum's "final" and starts singing: "Finale, oh oh oh oh". Lays her arm around B. B. Joins the singing, both sing. "Finale, oh oh oh oh".	acclamation, fan chant	

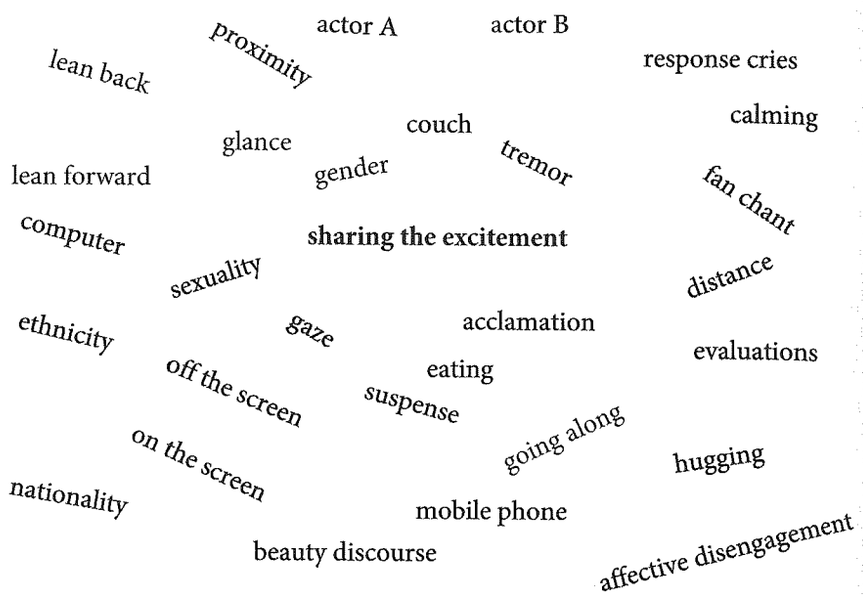

Figure 8.1 Relational analysis using messy situational map. Focus on "sharing the excitement" (working version).

some relevant codes and first concepts (simplified visualization). During the research and by engaging with the data we could further nuance and conceptualize the codes and concepts. Figure 8.2 shows a further situational map that we have made. It builds on concepts that are more abstract and includes the visualization of spatial and social structures of the reception situation.

A finding about relational analysis that was made possible by using the situational maps is that 'sharing the excitement' as an affective media practice is relevant *on both sides of the TV screen*. A relational analysis of the affective dynamics while watching TV shows how the viewers are involved in the TV show on an affective bodily level. When TV content is meant to arouse suspense, it addresses the bodies of the audience, which translates into affections like focused glance, body tension (e.g., lean-forward position), happy embraces, applause or fan chants. An affective media practice such as 'sharing the excitement' is linked to a cognitive assessment of the suspenseful media content. The discourses underlying those assessments are primarily related to (female) beauty and success. Frequently, while watching TV together, 'enlightened resistance' against the objectification of female bodies is less likely to be observed as disdainful remarks and insults: "What? She doesn't look like a model at all!", "She's way too fat to be a model", "She's so annoying with all her posturing", or "She's moving so

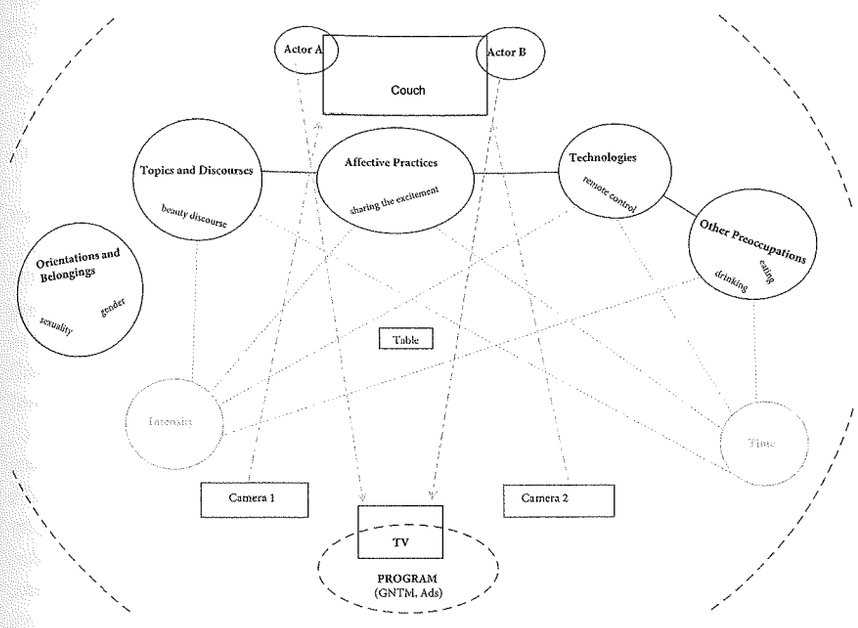

Figure 8.2 Relational analysis using abstract situational map.

ungracefully" are only some examples given here. Ludic contempt, insult and denigration are also visible in bodily reactions: one example here would be the bodily imitation of the model's performance, while denigrating her moves in the collective conversation. In this case, the relational analysis demonstrates how affective practices and discourse are closely related. The audience enjoys forms of judgment and devaluation of the candidates through the jury and partly takes a jury position itself by playfully 'sharing the excitement'. Thus, the evaluation of female bodies is adopted and performed as an affective practice through the reception process.

Our relational analysis shows that the creation of the affect is reinforced by further elements. For instance, it could be observed that the homely context and the position of the body on the sofa influence shared bodily excitement in an important way. The more the body of viewers 'melts' into the sofa to unwind, the more the activity potential and reaction capacity decreases. When the body disentangles itself from the sofa, slides to the edge and becomes more tense, the activity potential and reaction capacity increases. A relational analysis can thus demonstrate the importance of often neglected factors and make visible the constitutive character they have for the analysis of media practices. Furthermore, the relational analysis does not only show where connections are created but also where none emerge.

The shared excitement is not disturbed by other communication technologies (second screen, phone). Other media technologies are used repeatedly, but not in the moments of 'sharing the excitement'. It is therefore striking that viewers act out exactly this affective media practice without taking the mobile phone in their hands and being distracted by it. Thus, the relational analysis allows not only to show the existing relations between single elements, but also to make visible the constitutive role of what is *not done* for affection.

All in all, the relational analysis of the video material has made visible that the affection that occurs when people watch TV together develops relationally. These elements include the relation between the TV content, the TV device and the audience. In addition, the social interactions of the audience among themselves, the spatial organization with its artifacts and the practices linked to them (especially the use of second screens, the sofa, eating, drinking) as well as the discourses and socio-cultural positioning updated in the very moment of reception.

Our results show that viewers continuously negotiate the affective practices offered by the show they watch. For these considerations, we refer to Stuart Hall's (1980) encoding-decoding concept used to analyze the negotiation of meaning by the audience. However, here we do not refer solely to meanings and interpretations, but also to *affective practices* on the side of the audience. Being affected, however, is not a question of personal affiliation, but situational. Simple affective media practices range from laughing and singing all the way to hugging someone and crying out on both sides of the screen. A more complex and longer-lasting affective media practice is performed as 'sharing the excitement'. Overall, we found two different *forms* of affective media practices within our material with a special emphasis on bodily practices. With *practices of affective resonance* the affective registers offered by the media are being taken up physically and reenacted. By contrast, *practices of affective dissonance* show defense responses and activities of distancing oneself from the "commodity bodies" of the candidates as offered by the media.

Affective constructions/building of belonging

The situational maps alone cannot yet let us read how a sense of belonging is created by media practices. A higher level of theoretical abstraction is needed to achieve such an interpretation of the data. This can be accomplished by a simultaneous detailed analysis of some chosen sequences.

Based on our theoretical frame, three central levels of constructions of belonging can be identified: 1) locally situated communitization, 2) translocal mediated communitization and 3) symbolic communitization (by class, gender, ethnicity etc.). Following up on this, we switch to the analytic level, looking for the effects of affects. We want to briefly introduce our analysis discussing the role of affective media practices in the building of belonging. As a theoretical and heuristic

concept to identify different levels of belonging, we apply the term of *orientation*. Following Ahmed, affects make us follow specific orientations when we come into contact with bodies:

> What matters is itself an effect of proximities: we are touched by what comes near, just as what comes near is affected by directions we have already taken. Orientations are how the world acquires a certain shape through contact between bodies that are not in relation of exteriority.
>
> (2010, 234)

According to Ahmed, affects move human bodies towards other human bodies as well as towards things, technologies and places, but also away from them – following the logic of attraction and rejection. This process constructs objects as familiar or alien. Such affective orientations do not only come into consideration for material objects, but also when it comes to ideas and evaluations (Allhutter & Hofmann, 2014, 63). It becomes clear that affects and discourses cannot be considered separately. If we understand affects as a social-relational practice in media reception processes, it is possible to grasp empirically orientations and belongings.

At the first level, reception analysis raises the question of how on-site consumers of the TV show create, emphasize or break out of types of belongings (i.e. as couple, family or fans) in a bodily affective way. We understand the social setting of watching TV together as a *locally situated form of communitization*. The practice of joint watching organizes social relations as parents and children, friends or partners. The participants negotiate joint viewing preferences (within the family or as a couple) and organize rituals of joint viewing habits (e.g. the 'girls, TV evening'). These forms of belonging are affectively produced within the audiovisual material and embodied through performance on the side of the audience. In this context, the viewers do not just imitate the affective practices seen on the screen – for instance, hugging when they see a hug on TV – but in fact anticipate such practices before they have occurred on screen, and continually repeat such practices after seeing them. In other words, we see forms of reenactment as well as pre-enactment as part of habitual affective media practice (e.g., Silverman, 1996, 126ff.; Grusin, 2010). Alkemeyer (2006) has shown how fans at football games perform motions and bodily practices that not only *reenact* what happens on the field but frequently also *anticipate* it. In this regard it can be shown that fans update 'pre-existing' poses (Silverman, 1996, 202) and affective practices that connect them not only with the on-screen characters but also with other bodies in front of the screen. Figures 8.3 and 8.4 show that the viewers not only imitate the affective practices of excessive hugging, but also anticipate these practices. This becomes clear when we look at the timecode: both women hug each other, *before* it is shown on screen and at the same time they repeat affective practices that were staged several times.

Figure 8.3 Watching GNTM, Timecode: 02:10:44.

Figure 8.4 Screenshot GNTM, Timecode: 02:10:41.

Being together with friends and family offers opportunities for practices of *affective resonance* – a feeling of coziness on the audience side. Looking in more detail at these concepts of 'home', we suggest that the cultural proximity of these 'settings of home' – in terms of gender, class or cultural/ethnic background – regulates the intensities of affects on the audience's side. Thus, while offering coziness as a 'good feeling' in the living room, the power of reality TV lies in the patterns of distinction and exclusion along the lines of gender, class, culture, ethnicity that are acted out in affective practices.

On a second level, an affective media practice like "sharing the excitement" can be read as a *form of affective participation* in the show. In particular, the 'final decision' at the end of each episode provokes a definitive positioning as fan or critic of a certain character, as we showed earlier. We argue that taking part in watching a reality TV show embodies the participation in certain ways of life and everyday culture, which connects us with others. Based on habitual media consumption and knowledge about the genre and its promises, only those members of the audience who are familiar with these forms of consumption and culture and who find their preferences and values as part of this culture will eventually be able to participate (Alkemeyer, 2006). Affective media practices are only performed by those human bodies that are affected by this specific way of life. The affective participation and the pleasure created by the show become clearly visible in the orientation of the bodies (e.g. focused gaze, hugging), and they can also be expressed through linguistic expressions (e.g. response cries) or by verbal communicating (e.g. "that moved me"). Affective practices are then understood as the connecting force between the bodies of viewers and television, whether as technology, representation, staging or genre. Thus, the belonging to an (imagined) *translocally constituted community of other viewers* becomes visible.

The third level – that can be made visible using the video footage – is centered around the problem of how the audience's affective practices create and change national, gendered, ethnic, sexual or other kinds of belonging based on *modes of symbolic communitization*. By doing so, affective practices can be analyzed as a means of constructing and negotiating belonging that is created following the logics of linking or separating through action (i.e. doing ethnicity, othering, doing gender). It becomes clear that the viewers often show defense responses and that they are distancing themselves from the 'commodity bodies' of the candidates offered in the TV show. This is what we call *practices of affective dissonance*. We would like to illustrate this with one last example. Figure 8.5 shows a screenshot of GTNM during a "Cosmopolitan shooting". For this occasion, all candidates are trained to perform specific standardized body postures. In this way, the individual bodies of the protagonists are incorporated into a gendered and consumable 'commodity body'. Figure 8.6 shows a screenshot of a girl watching the show together with friends in front of her TV set. She notices these performative body representations and comments on the way one of the candidates performs her commodified body ("What the hell is she doing?") while imitating her body language. This way, a verbal dissociation with the commodity bodies takes place,

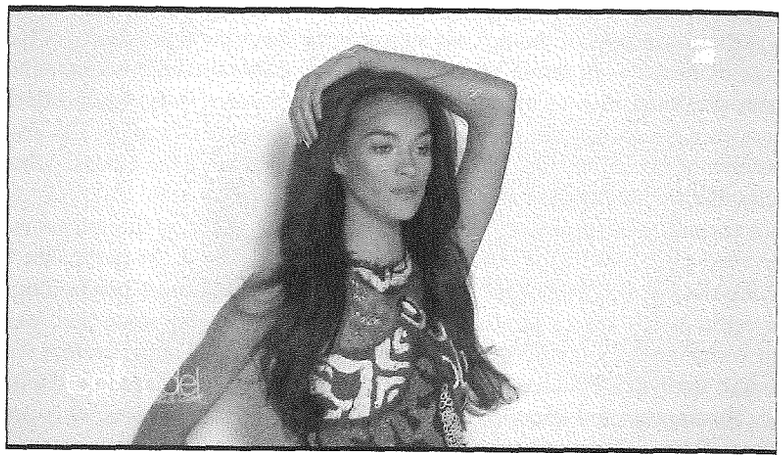

Figure 8.5 Screenshot GNTM.

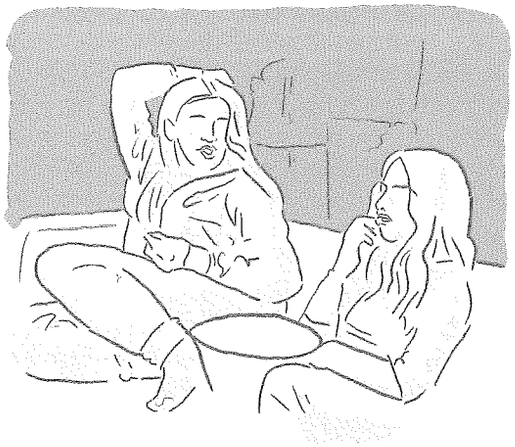

Figure 8.6 Watching GNTM.

while the offered bodily expressions are being imitated physically. This can be characterized as simultaneity of verbal distancing, bodily imitation and playful staging. A video analysis can show how recipients repeat or negotiate affectively grounded gender norms and conventions through media-oriented practices. This also sheds light on the fact that affects and gender norms do not arise out of the bodies of the individual actors but come up relationally through interactions with publicly circulating gender representations.

5. Evaluation

Focusing on affective media practices requires visualization methods to investigate the temporality, relativity and intensity of the social-relational phenomena. Forms of video analysis are particularly suited to capturing the affective dynamics of media practices. Video analysis makes it possible to include undefined and volatile phenomena such as affects within a detailed analysis. The implementation of digital recording formats has dramatically widened the opportunities to use and analyze video footage. These opportunities include recording everyday reception practices with mobile phone cameras, for instance, or editing video footage through the synchronization of different footage, as well as the availability of certain tools of analysis, such as split-screen analysis or using special software created for the analysis of video footage.[1]

However, a basic constraint of video analysis lies in the construction of the visual through the lens of a camera. Mostly, researchers can only see an extract of the world through the footage. Video footage can never be "natural data", but are always already representations, excerpts and evaluations of social worlds. They cannot reflect reality because they are a social practice themselves, producing an academic view on everyday practices. The video camera in a living room is never a 'fly on the wall' but produces a specific type of observation material that is constrained by its positioning, the perspective of the camera and the camera motion, light or colors. Social reality itself is never directly empirically accessible – neither by tools of observation nor by surveys or video analysis. These fundamental epistemological assumptions of constructivism need to be taken into account. However, the respective co-constructions can be identified, reflected upon and debated (Charmaz, 2006).

Further limitations of video analysis of everyday media reception are also linked to the recruitment of candidates. Limits are set to what happens when a camera is set up in a private space. As already pointed out, not only does the researcher make a selection, but the research participants as well take part in an "auto-selection": what kind of person is willing to be filmed while watching TV in their everyday life at home or in other places? As we were interested in the social and cultural diversity of audience members, we need to take into account the limitations arising from social regulations about the willingness or reluctance to produce visible representation of the private home.

Video material allows for an analysis of multimodal communication including verbal and non-verbal articulation, body movements and social and environmental

settings in its relational character (see Knudsen & Stage, 2015). All these elements become visible and applicable for analysis *in its temporal structure*. It is especially this opportunity to rely on the rhythm – here especially consisting of periods of calmness and boredom – alternating with periods of high intensity and intensive involvement.

With regard to the analysis of affects, the following conclusions can be drawn for video analysis: The situationally bound, relational affective occurrence is in no case directly accessible. Video recordings enable a specific detection and reproduction of a singular event. The benefit is undoubtedly the ability to sequentially reconstruct the complex, relational setting in its temporal dynamics.

However, there is no doubt that an independent analytic formation of the event is already taking place. The selection of participants, as well as the empirical access to the field via the camera, constitutes interventions in an everyday event. Just as affect research is constantly shaped by the researchers' own affections *vis-a-vis* the empirical material they collect, so too must the conditions of data collection always be understood as constitutive of affective events.

Affect research must consider this invasive characteristic in at least two ways. On the one hand – as we have sought to explain here – these very conditions of data collection and analysis are to be included transparently and reflexively in the evaluation process. On the other hand, multi-method approaches can correct this invasive character of the analysis. In addition to forms of video analysis, forms of questioning, memory work or media diaries can also be used to include self-descriptions of the spectators' affective experience.

The increasingly complex conditions of media reception – wherein audiovisual media are watched on different and increasingly mobile platforms – demand ever more complex research settings. While watching TV at home has been theorized in terms of globalization (Morley, 2005), the mobile availability and the diverse, fluid and less stable settings of media use need to be worked out profoundly in terms of their affective dynamics. We could observe members of the audience using a second screen, such as a smartphone or tablet, while watching television, thus divvying their attention between different media attractions. Current mobile forms of using audiovisual media, however, are changing these dynamics profoundly, as users engage in such media on public transport, during any kind of break, or even as entertainment in the schoolyard. Using audiovisual media here becomes part of other social practices of sharing, inscribed into mediated environments. Analyzing affective media practices in these mobile, digitalized contexts demands new research settings. But at the same time the relational character of affect *as part of social practices* here becomes even more apparent.

Note

1 As a software for the transcription and analysis of video data, the following programs are offered: InqScribe, Transana, Feldpartitur SaaS Micro, Nvivio, MAXQDA, Dedoose, Digital Replay System (DRS).

References

Ahmed, S 2010, 'Orientations Matter', in D Coole & S Frost (eds.), *New Materialism*, pp. 234–257, Duke University Press, Durham.

Alkemeyer, T 2006, 'Rhythmen, Resonanzen und Missklänge. Über die Körperlichkeit der Produktion des Sozialen im Spiel', in R Gugutzer (ed.), *Body Turn. Perspektiven der Soziologie des Körpers und des Sports*, pp. 265–296, Transcript Verlag, Bielefeld.

Allhutter, D & Hofmann, R 2014, 'Affektive Materialitäten in Geschlechter-Technikverhältnissen. Handlungs- und theoriepolitische Implikationen einer antikategorialen Geschlechteranalyse', *Freiburger Zeitschrift für Geschlechterstudien*, vol. 20, no. 2, pp. 59–78.

Angerer, ML 2017, *Ecology of Affect: Intensive Milieus and Contingent Encounters*, Meson Press, Lüneburg.

Bakardjieva, M 2005, *Internet Society: The Internet in Everyday Life*, Sage Publications, Los Angeles.

Blackman, L & Venn, C 2010, 'Affect', *Body & Society*, vol. 16, no. 1, pp. 7–28. Available from: https://doi.org/10.1177/1357034X09354769 [1 August 2018].

Bourdieu, P 1977, *Outline of a Theory of Practice*, Cambridge, Cambridge University Press.

Bratich, J 2007, 'Programming reality: Control societies, new subjects and the power of transformation', in D Heller (ed.), *Makeover Television. Realities Remodeled*, pp. 6–22, I.B. Tauris, London, New York.

Bratich, J 2010, 'Affective convergence in reality television. A case study in divergence culture', in M Kackman, M Binfield, MT Payne, A Perlman & B Sebok (eds.), *Flow TV: Essays on a Convergent Medium*, pp. 55–74, Routledge, London.

Breger, C 2014, 'Configuring affect: Complex world making in fatih Akın's Auf der anderen Seite (The Edge of Heaven)', *Cinema Journal*, vol. 54, no. 1, pp. 65–87.

Charmaz, K 2006, *Constructing Grounded Theory: A Practical Guide Through Qualitative Analysis*, Sage Publications, London.

Clarke, AE 2005, *Situational Analysis: Grounded Theory After the Postmodern Turn*, Sage Publications, Thousand Oaks.

Clough, PT 2000, *Autoaffection: Unconscious Thought in the Age of Technology*, University of Minnesota Press, Minneapolis.

Clough, PT 2007, 'Introduction', in PT Clough & J Halley (eds.), *The Affective Turn: Theorizing the Social*, pp. 1–33, Duke University Press, Durham, London.

Coleman, R 2013, *Transforming Images. Screens, Affect, Futures*, Routledge, Chapman & Hall, London.

Couldry, N 2004, 'Theorising media as practice', *Social Semiotics*, vol. 14, pp. 115–132.

Couldry, N 2012, *Media, Society, World: Social Theory and Digital Media Practice*, Polity Press, Cambridge.

Couldry, N, Livingstone, S & Markham, T 2007, *Media Consumption and Public Engagement: Beyond the Presumption of Attention*, Palgrave Macmillan, Basingstoke.

Dinkelaker, J & Herrle, M 2009, *Erziehungswissenschaftliche Videographie: Eine Einführung*, VS, Wiesbaden.

Fahlenbrach, K 2010, *Audiovisuelle Metaphern. Zur Körper- und Affektästhetik in Film und Fernsehen*, Schüren Verlag, Marburg.

Garfinkel, H 1967, 'Studies of the routine grounds of everyday activities', in idem., *Studies in Ethnomethodology*, pp. 35–75, Prentice Hall, Englewood Cliffs.

Gibbs, A 2011, 'Affect theory and audience', in V Nightingale (ed.), *The Handbook of Media Audiences*, pp. 251–266, Wiley-Blackwell, West Sussex.
Gibbs, GR 2007, *Analyzing Qualitative Data*, Sage Publications, London.
Gjedde, L & Ingemann, B 2008, *Researching Experiences; Exploring Processual and Experimental Methods in Cultural Analsysis*, Cambridge Scholars Publishing, Newcastle.
Gregg, M & Seigworth, G (eds.), 2010, *The Affect Theory Reader*, Duke University Press, Durham, London.
Grüne, A 2016, *Formatierte Weltkultur? Zur Theorie und Praxis globalen Unterhaltungsfernsehens*, Transcript Verlag, Bielefeld.
Grusin, RA 2010, *Premediation: Affect and Mediality After 9/11*, Palgrave Macmillan, Basingstoke, New York.
Hall, S 1980, 'Encoding/decoding', in Centre for Contemporary Cultural Studies (ed.), *Culture, Media, Language: Working Papers in Cultural Studies, 1972–79*, pp. 128–138, Hutchinson, London.
Hall, S 1997, *Representation: Cultural Representations and Signifying Practices*, Sage Publications, London.
Hartmann, M 2013, 'From domestication to mediated mobilism', *Mobile Media & Communication*, vol. 1, pp. 42–49.
Heath, C, Hindmarsh, J & Luff, P 2010, *Video in Qualitative Research: Analysing Social Interaction in Everyday Life*, Sage Publications, London.
Hillebrandt, F 2014, *Soziologische Praxistheorien. Eine Einführung*, Springer VS, Wiesbaden.
Irion, T 2002, 'Einsatz von Digitaltechnologien bei der Erhebung, Aufbereitung und Analyse multicodaler Daten', *Forum Qualitative Sozialforschung/Forum: Qualitative Social Research*, vol. 3, no. 2. Available from: www.qualitative-research.net/index.php/fqs/article/view/855 [1 August 2018].
Kavka, M 2008, *Reality Television, Affect and Intimacy: Reality Matters*, Palgrave Macmillan, Houndmills.
Kavka, M 2014, 'A matter of feeling: Mediated affect in reality television', in L Ouellette (ed.), *A Companion to Reality Television*, pp. 459–477, Wiley, Malden, Oxford, Sussex.
Kissmann, U (ed.), 2009, *Video Interaction Analysis*, Peter Lang, Frankfurt am Main.
Knoblauch, H 2012, 'Introduction to the special issue of qualitative research: Video-analysis and videography', *Qualitative Research*, vol. 12, no. 3, pp. 251–254.
Knoblauch, H, Schnettler, B & Raab, J 2006, 'Video-analysis: Methodological aspects of interpretive audio visual analysis in social research', in H Knoblauch, B Schnettler, J Raab & HG Soeffner (eds.), *Video Analysis. Methodology and Methods. Qualitative Audiovisual Data Analysis in Sociology*, pp. 9–28, Peter Lang, Frankfurt am Main.
Knoblauch, H, Schnettler, B & Tuma, R 2014, *Videography. Introduction to Interpretive Videoanalysis of Social Situations*, Peter Lang, Frankfurt am Main, Bern.
Knudsen, B & Stage, C 2015, 'Introduction: Affective methodologies', in idem., *Affective Methodologies. Developing Cultural Resarch Strategies for the Study of Affect*, pp. 1–24, Palgrave Macmillan, Houndsmill.
Kraidy, M & Sender, K (eds.), 2011, *The Politics of Reality Television. Global Perspectives*, Routledge, New York.
Krajina, Z, Moores, S & Morley, D 2014, 'Non-media-centric media studies: A cross-generational conversation', *European Journal of Cultural Studies*, vol. 17, pp. 682–700.
Lefebvre, H 2014, *Critique of Everyday Life*, Verso, London.
Mathar, T 2008, 'Making a mess with situational analysis? Review essay', *FQS*, vol. 9, no. 2.

Morley, D 2005, *Home Territories: Media, Mobility and Identity*, Routledge, London.
Ortner, SB 1996, 'Making gender: Toward a feminist, minority, postcolonial, subaltern, etc. Theory of practice', in SB Ortner (ed.), *Making Gender: The Politics and Erotics of Culture*, pp. 1–20, Beacon Press, Boston.
Pink, S 2001, *Doing Ethnography: Images, Media and Representation in Research*, Sage Publications, London.
Pink, S 2006, *The Future of Visual Anthropology: Engaging the Senses*, Routledge, London.
Postill, J & Bräuchler, B 2010, *Theorising Media and Practice*, Berghahn Books, New York.
Reckwitz, A 2002a, 'The status of the "Material" in theories of culture: From "Social Structure" to "Artefacts"', *Journal for the Theory of Social Behaviour*, vol. 32, pp. 195–217.
Reckwitz, A 2002b, 'Toward a theory of social practices: A development in culturalist theorizing', *European Journal of Social Theory*, vol. 5, pp. 243–263.
Reckwitz, A 2003, 'Grundelemente einer Theorie sozialer Praktiken: Eine sozialtheoretische Perspektive', *Zeitschrift für Soziologie*, vol. 32, no. 4, pp. 282–301.
Reckwitz, A 2017, 'Practices and their affects', in A Hui, T Schatzki & E Shove (eds.), *The Nexus of Practices*, pp. 114–125, Routledge, Milton Park.
Rose, G 2006, *Visual Methodologies. An Introduction to the Interpretation of Visual Materials*, Routledge, London.
Röser, J, Thomas, T & Peil, C 2010, *Alltag in den Medien – Medien im Alltag*, VS Verlag für Sozialwissenschaften, Wiesbaden.
Schatzki, TR 1996, *Social Practices: A Wittgensteinian Approach to Human Activity and the Social*, Cambridge University Press, Cambridge.
Schatzki, TR 2002, *The Site of the Social: A Philosophical Account of the Constitution of Social Life and Change*, Pennsylvania State University Press, University Park.
Schatzki, TR, Knorr-Cetina, K & von Savigny, E 2001, *The Practice Turn in Contemporary Theory*, Routledge, London.
Schünzel, A & Knoblauch, H 2017, 'Videographie und videoanalyse', in C Wegener & L Mikos (eds.), *Qualitative Medienanalyse. Ein Handbuch*, UTB, Stuttgart.
Silverman, K 1996, *The Threshold of the Visible World*, Routledge, New York.
Skeggs, B & Wood, K 2012, *Reacting to Reality Television: Performance, Audience and Value*, Routledge, New York.
Slaby, J, Mühlhoff, R & Wüschner, P 2016, 'Affektive Relationalität. Umrisse eines philosophischen Forschungsprogramms', in U Eberlein (ed.), *Zwischenleiblichkeit – Intercorporeity, Movement and Tacit Knowledge*, pp. 69–108, Transcript Verlag, Bielefeld.
Smith, DE 1987, *The Everyday World as Problematic. A Feminist Sociology*, Northeastern University Press, Athens.
von Scheve, C 2017, 'A social relational account of affect', *European Journal of Social Theory*, vol. 1, no. 21, pp. 39–59.
Wetherell, M 2012, *Affect and Emotion: A New Social Science Understanding*, Sage Publications, Los Angeles, London.
Wetherell, M 2015, 'Trends in the turn to affect: A social psychological critique', *Body & Society*, vol. 21, no. 2, pp. 139–166.
Wood, H 2007, 'The mediated conversational floor: An interactive approach to audience reception analysis', *Media, Culture & Society*, vol. 29, no. 1, pp. 75–103.
Wood, H 2009, *Talking with Television. Women, Talk Shows, and Modern Self-Reflexivity*, University of Illinois Press, Urbana.